

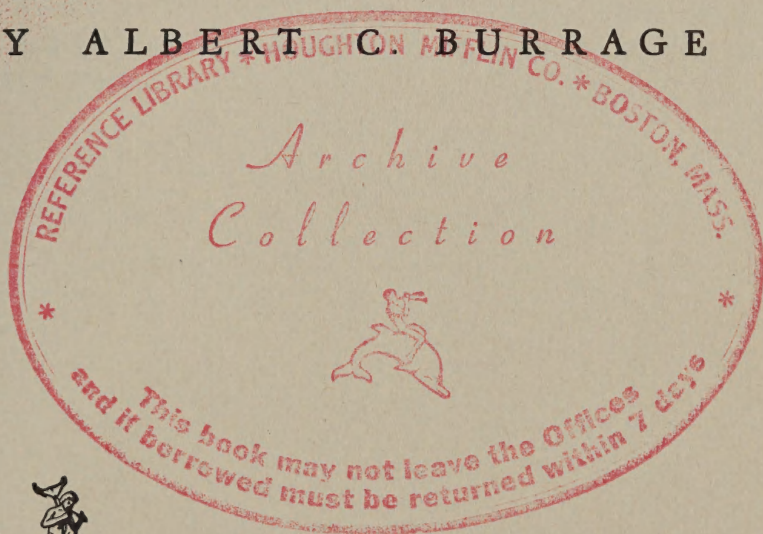
THE
Twenty-Minute-a-Day
GARDEN

BY
ALBERT C.
BURRAGE

HOUGHTON MIFFLIN COMPANY

THE TWENTY-MINUTE-A-DAY GARDEN

BY ALBERT C. BURRAGE



HOUGHTON MIFFLIN COMPANY · BOSTON

The Riverside Press Cambridge

1943

COPYRIGHT, 1943, BY ALBERT C. BURRAGE

ALL RIGHTS RESERVED INCLUDING THE RIGHT TO REPRODUCE
THIS BOOK OR PARTS THEREOF IN ANY FORM

The Riverside Press
CAMBRIDGE · MASSACHUSETTS
PRINTED IN THE U.S.A.

PUBLISHER'S NOTE



THE result of many years' experimentation, the garden described in the following pages should serve as a valuable model to the beginner and challenge to the expert. Compact and efficient, it is specifically designed to save time and space. From this garden, twenty-five by fifty feet, Mr. Burrage supplies his family of four with vegetables from June through October. By means of progressive photographs, charts, and detailed directions, he tells exactly how he does it. Mr. Burrage's description of his garden makes the perfect complement to Mr. Dempsey's already standard work.

PART I — REPORT ON THE 1942 GARDEN

1. THE PURPOSE OF THE GARDEN	9
2. YIELDS PER MONTH	12
3. 1942 CROPS — AMOUNTS AND VALUES, COSTS	14
4. HOURS WORKED 1942	16

PART II — PLANS FOR THE 1943 GARDEN

5. CROPS — AMOUNTS AND VALUES	19
6. GARDEN PLANS	20
7. EXPECTED DATES	21
8. PLANTING SCHEDULE FOR GARDEN	22
9. SEED LIST	23
10. STARTING THE GARDEN	24
11. VARIETIES	27

PART III — RECORDS TO BE KEPT

12. ACTUAL DATES	33
13. HOURS WORKED	34
14. DAILY GARDEN YIELDS	35
15. REQUEST FOR INFORMATION	41

P A R T

I

THE PURPOSE OF THE GARDEN

*Prove All Things
Hold Fast That Which Is Good*

THE TWENTY-MINUTE-A-DAY GARDEN

THE garden described herein, twenty-five by fifty feet, was taken care of by a skillful gardener in thirty minutes a day during April, May, and June and in less than fifteen minutes a day during July, August, September, and October, or an average of twenty minutes per day. This does not include the time of picking the vegetables. A novice will take perhaps fifty per cent longer.

The garden twenty-five by fifty feet will provide fresh vegetables for four people.

The information given is merely a report on a specific garden — what actually was done and what was accomplished. It does not purport to be a new discovery or a new kind of gardening. However, the garden is efficient and it does work. Suggestions are made for improving the garden, and tables are included for making a complete detailed record of your own garden.

The garden described is located in Ipswich, Massachusetts, about thirty miles north of Boston, and about three miles from the sea so that it is favored with an excellent climate. The frost leaves the ground during March and the first frost arrives about October 7. The dates given are all those used in Ipswich. For other parts of the country, there would have to be an adjustment based on comparative conditions.

In 1942, a year of normal rainfall, no artificial watering was used.

The total footage of the rows grown in this garden, owing to its design, is very much greater than the footage of the rows grown in the usual home garden of the same area, hence the unusual yield.

PART

I

REPORT ON THE 1942 GARDEN

THE PURPOSE OF THE GARDEN

THE two really important reasons for having a garden are:

1. There probably will be a shortage of vegetables while the war is on, beginning in the spring or summer of 1943, and a supply of your own may be of the greatest importance.

2. Vegetables of the quality raised in a home garden cannot be obtained in the market. Peas and corn picked at their peak are entirely different in quality from those sold in markets, which are usually at least thirty-six hours old and which are not picked at their peak to start with.

The purpose of the writer was to have a small vegetable garden suitable for a back-yard, and yet big enough to supply four people and to grow the maximum quantity of vegetables with the minimum amount of expense and water and with labor of a skillful gardener limited to an average through the season of twenty minutes per day. This is accomplished by the design of the garden, by conservation of moisture, and by the selection of the most suitable varieties of vegetables for this design. A novice at gardening can use this garden plan just as easily as any other plan, but will naturally require more time than a skillful gardener. The work that the latter can do per hour is fairly definite, and therefore was used as a means of measuring the time required.

The information given herewith is based on actual experience during the summer of 1942 and is an actual garden diary. The yields as given are exact. The reported amounts are given in pounds, heads, and bunches, just as you would buy them. This statement shows what the garden actually did.

There was, however, an actual deficiency in fertilizer and manure. With the manure and fertilizer used as suggested, even greater yields

can be assured. No hand watering was done, as it was desired to see how the garden would do with only rain as the source for water. The rainfall in 1942 was exactly normal. It therefore has been found that excellent results can be obtained in at least normal years without hand watering. It is believed, however, that if a little hand watering were done by hose and sprinkler, even better results could be obtained. Based on the experience of this and similar gardens, it is believed that the predicted yields can be relied upon provided the gardening plans are followed out.

The purpose of reporting the exact figures as to the hours of work required each day, the cost, yield, and value of the crop is to enable the would-be gardener to decide if he has the requisite time, etc., available to produce a given quantity and value of vegetables.

The Design of the Garden. This garden was laid out east and west, and directions run accordingly. It could have been laid out equally well in any other direction. The design utilized the following points:

1. The vegetables are planted close together; that is, about one half the usual distance apart.

2. Corn and peas are planted over the entire garden area, but in such a way as to allow the other vegetables to grow between them. This is done by planting the corn in hills with prior and follow crops in the same row; by planting dwarf peas which will fall on the ground before they are fully grown, and by planting Limas and tomatoes, which are very tall plants, in the pea row. Before the peas are harvested, follow crops are planted six inches to one side of the rows.

3. The tall-growing tomatoes, widely spaced on poles, are grown with only one main stem, which is kept free of fruit and leaves for the lower twenty inches, to prevent shading of other crops.

4. The tall-growing Limas are widely spaced in the same way.

5. The tall vegetables, being scattered, do not shade the lower-growing ones and are clear gain as regards space. Low-growing prior crops are grown between the corn hills and bean and tomato poles.

6. Low-growing follow crops are grown six inches to one side of the tall vegetables after the prior crops.

7. Higher-growing follow crops are grown after the peas, six inches to the side. This allows them to be planted while the peas are still growing.

8. The width of the garden is twenty-five feet. Thirteen rows are

planted in this width. While this may seem too narrow, nevertheless it is sufficient. The garden can be made wider, but no better results will be obtained and it will take more hours to care for it, about in proportion to its extra width.

9. The garden must be in full sunshine from morning to night. No matter what else is done, the garden cannot be successful without full sunshine.

CONSERVATION OF MOISTURE

Conservation of moisture is obtained by:

1. Planting the rows close together which shades the soil.
2. Spreading peat moss over the garden which acts as a sponge to absorb the rain and as an insulator to keep the earth cool.
3. Using dwarf peas, which fall flat on the ground and help shade the earth.

SELECTION OF VARIETIES

The varieties were selected after careful comparative tests of both culinary and horticultural qualities lasting over many years. On many occasions there were three or more varieties of one vegetable tried at one meal. The best-tasting variety was chosen by voting and in most cases the decision was unanimous. Few people realize what a tremendous difference there is between the quality of the average variety of vegetable and that of the best. It is about comparable to the difference between a rainy day and a nice sunny day. No variety was selected unless the quality of taste was excellent and the horticultural qualities satisfactory.

The yields of each vegetable are given for each time they were picked.

The yields are measured in pounds, quarts, heads, and bunches.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	Totals
																							2		2		2				2	8

Spinach, pounds

Spinach, pounds

[illegible]

Beet greens, pounds

Onions, quarts

[illegible]

Beets, bunches

Beets, bunches

Peas, quarts

Carrots, bunches

Beans, *quarts*

Potatoes, quarts

Tomatoes, pounds

Beet greens, pounds

YIELDS, 1942

Continued

AUGUST

[illegible]

SEPTEMBER

[illegible]

OCTOBER

[illegible]

GROW YOUR OWN VEGETABLES

1942 CROPS — AMOUNTS AND VALUES

<i>Vegetables</i>	<i>No. of Hills</i>	<i>Feet of Row-Net</i>	<i>Pounds</i>	<i>Fruit Heads or Ears</i>	<i>Value per lb.</i>	<i>Total Value</i>
Beans.....		190	42		\$.12	\$5.04
Beets.....		90	64		.08	5.12
Beet greens.....			13		.07	.91
Brussels sprouts..		25	8		.25	2.00
Carrots.....		90	85		.08	6.80
Eggplant.....		25		5	.15	.75
Limas..... 15			17		.15	2.55
Onion, sets.....		50	15		.05	.75
Parsnips.....		50	15		.05	.75
Peas.....		200	84		.12	10.00
Potatoes.....		50	42		.025	1.05
Spinach, Blooms- dale Savoy....		90	15		.07	1.05
Tomatoes..... 18			78		.08	6.24
Lettuce.....		50		21	.15	3.15
Corn..... 112				335	.025	8.38
Totals..... 145		910	468	361		\$54.54

THE STORY OF
THE TWENTY-MINUTE-A-DAY GARDEN
IN PHOTOGRAPHS

FROM
APRIL
THROUGH
NOVEMBER



APRIL 19

I

The curtain is just about to go up on Act I. Plowing, harrowing, manuring, and fertilizing were done about March 20, then the poles sunk in readiness for tomatoes and Limas, and the first peas planted by the 28th. All that is needed now is twenty minutes a day, skillfully applied in accordance with the accompanying charts and directions. The plot is 25×50 feet.



APRIL 26

II

The peas planted March 28 are well above ground, and spinach, at the left, is beginning to show. Other early plantings — beets, carrots, onions, and parsnips — have already been made. Likewise, a second planting of peas, for the summer succession. Proper spacing is important.



MAY 12

III

The general plan of the garden becomes apparent. All *prior* crops have now been planted, in rows about $2\frac{1}{2}$ feet apart, and about half of the *main* crops, so that by the middle of May nearly half the garden has been planted. *Follow* crops go in later. Three or four spaced plantings of lettuce are recommended.



MAY 17

IV

Full sun is a requisite for strong and steady growth. Not a weed can be seen and very few will grow through the $\frac{1}{2}$ -inch covering of peat moss which has gradually been spread over the entire surface. Corn and peas are planted over the whole garden, but in such a way as to allow other vegetables to grow between them.



MAY 17

V

This lateral view shows how the peas are grown up to within 1 foot of the poles, leaving sufficient space for the Limas and tomatoes, for which the poles have been firmly set at least 2 feet down to prevent wobbling. For maximum results, every inch of the garden plot must be made to count.



JUNE 14

VI

By the middle of June, most of the garden work has been done. The record shows that only twenty-four more hours' work is necessary before the end of the season. The pea vines, having reached their maximum growth, will soon fall over, shading the ground and conserving moisture. Healthy beets (this is the *prior* crop) indicate a properly limed and fertilized soil.



JULY 5

VII

The beans have just started to bear and the tomatoes, now 3 feet high, are growing vigorously. Trained to the poles for support, only one stem is kept for the bearing of fruit. By removing the lower branches and leaves, the shading of lower-growing crops is avoided.



AUGUST 14

VIII

All this for something over twenty dollars. The garden is at its height — corn twice a day, plenty of beets, carrots, beans, and tomatoes. The growth is luxuriant, in spite of the fact that the garden has not had a drop of artificial water. Nineteen-forty-two was a summer of normal rainfall.



AUGUST 14

IX

Four people were well fed from this garden. Observe the corn just visible in the beet row. When the beets have been pulled, the corn will take over as a *main* crop, and begin bearing in September. In this row there will obviously be no *follow* crop.



AUGUST 23

X

The late corn is not as thick as the early corn, but satisfactorily extends the season. Now there is no room for a weed, nor a square foot of bare ground, parched and baking. Peat moss and natural shade are both utilized to conserve moisture.



SEPTEMBER 5

XI

Avoid this mistake. The corn could not grow through the carrots because the carrots were planted too early and the corn too late. The timing, not the grouping, was at fault. Note the well-formed bean-pods at the extreme right.



SEPTEMBER 13

XII

More fruit and fewer leaves, as the season approaches harvest-time. See how the tomatoes and climbing Limas are widely spaced so as not to throw too much shade. The principal occupation now is picking, eating, canning, and preserving. Waste is not tolerated and the dividends are beginning to pay.



SEPTEMBER 30

XIII

As the *prior* crops yielded to the *main* crops, so do the *main* crops yield to the *follow* crops. Brussels sprouts stand the frost well and produce until late November. Parsnips, beets, carrots, and late spinach all replenish the fall table.



OCTOBER 15

XIV

There has been a general clean-up after the first killing frost, and only *follow* crops are left. This is the fall garden. The turnips, which should now be ready, failed for want of sufficient light. They will be used to advantage, however, in a mixed vegetable soup.



NOVEMBER 25

XV

The garden has been manured and the ground turned over. Boards have been placed along the edges. The rows have been measured off and marked. The garden is now ready for next year. In the spring all that remains to be done is to fertilize, set in the poles, and start planting, according to schedule.

COSTS

Beans, Stringless Green Pod	3 lbs.	\$.90	
Beets, Harvard	¼ lb.	1.50	
Brussels sprouts, Catskill	1 pkt.	.50	
Carrots, Golden Beauty	½ oz.	.35	
Corn, Golden Bantam, Massachusetts grown	¾ lb.	.30	
Eggplant, Early Long Purple	1 pkt.	.15	
Lettuce, May King	1 pkt.	.15	
Lettuce, Imperial Number 44	1 pkt.	.15	
Limas, Pole, Sieva	½ lb.	.25	
Onion Sets, Japanese Yellow Globe	1 lb.	.35	
Parsnip, Hollow Crown	½ oz.	.20	
Peas, Little Marvel	4 lbs.	1.50	
Potato, Irish Cobblers	½ pk.	.40	
Spinach, Bloomsdale Savoy	2 oz.	.40	
Spinach, New Zealand	1 oz.	.20	
Tomato, Rutgers	1 pkt.	.10	\$7.40
Fertilizer	50 lbs.	1.50	
Peat moss	1 bale	4.50	
Manure	½ cord	6.00	
Greentox	1 pint	2.00	
Rotenone dust	2 lbs.	.50	
Snarol	4 lbs.	.85	15.35
			22.75
Total			22.75
Plus for first year only:			
30 poles	4.00		
Plowing and disk harrowing	3.00		
Total for first year only			7.00
			\$29.75

After the first year the cost of the garden will be about \$22 per year.

GROW YOUR OWN VEGETABLES

HOURS WORKED 1942

	OCT.	MAR.	APR.	MAY	JUNE	JULY	AUG.	SEPT.	OCT.
1			1		$\frac{1}{4}$				
2			$\frac{1}{2}$		1				
3			$\frac{1}{4}$				1		
4			$\frac{1}{2}$			4 $\frac{1}{2}$	$1 \frac{1}{2}$		
5				1	$1 \frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$			
6			1	$1 \frac{1}{2}$					
7						$1 \frac{1}{4}$	$1 \frac{1}{2}$		
8			$1 \frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	2				
9			1		$\frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{1}{2}$			
10									
11							1		1
12			1						
13			$1 \frac{1}{2}$	1	1			$2 \frac{1}{2}$	
14			$1 \frac{1}{2}$		6				
15				$1 \frac{1}{2}$					
16			2	$\frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{1}{4}$			
17									
18					$\frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{1}{2}$		
19			$1 \frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{3}{4}$				
20			1						2
21						1			
22				$1 \frac{3}{4}$		1			
23			$\frac{1}{2}$	$1 \frac{3}{4}$	$1 \frac{1}{2}$				
24				$1 \frac{1}{2}$		1			2
25				1			$\frac{3}{4}$		
26				$1 \frac{1}{2}$					
27		1							
28		1							
29		1		1			$\frac{1}{2}$		
30								$\frac{1}{2}$	
31				$\frac{1}{4}$					
	3		$14 \frac{3}{4}$	$14 \frac{3}{4}$	$14 \frac{3}{4}$	$9 \frac{1}{2}$	$6 \frac{3}{4}$	3	5
	Total								
	71 $\frac{1}{2}$								

Total hours worked 71 $\frac{1}{2}$

Months 8

Average per month 9

Average per day (minutes) . . 20

This is the time actually worked by a skillful gardener. A beginner would probably take more time in performing the necessary operations and would want to spend more time tinkering.

Approximately this time was spent doing the following:

12 hours	Preparing soil
8 hours	Setting poles
15 hours	Weeding
20 hours	Planting
2 hours	Tying and pinching tomatoes
<u>15 hours</u>	<u>Pulling up crops</u>
72 hours	

P A R T

II

PLANS FOR THE 1943 GARDEN

PART

II

PLANS FOR THE 1943 GARDEN

25' x 50'

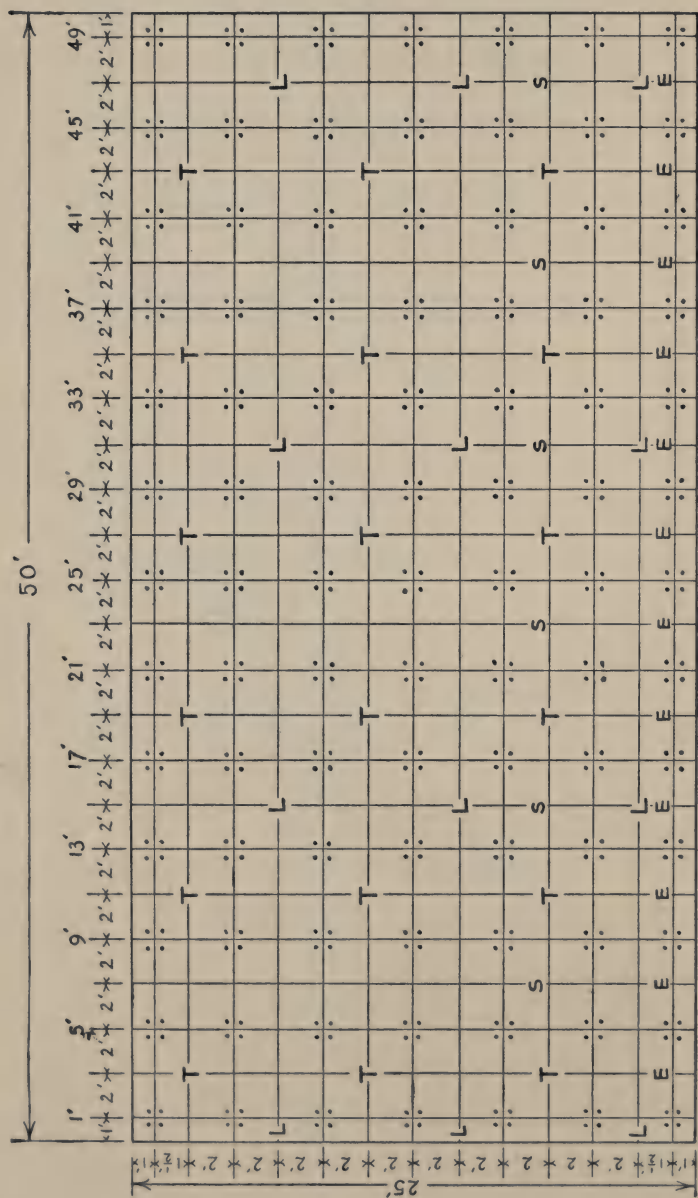
If you do have a garden, don't make it larger than you have time for. Adjust the garden size to your available time, and also to the size of your family. A garden twenty-five by fifty feet will provide fresh vegetables for four people. For three people, make it twenty-five by forty feet; and for two, make it twenty-five by thirty feet.

Above all things, pick a good and sunny location.

50'

Plant row with Potatoes			Follow with Spinach	and	13 Hills of Corn	spaced 4' apart		
"	"	" Beans	"	" Beans	6 Pole Tomatoes	"	8'	"
"	"	" Carrots			13 Hills of Corn	"	4'	"
"	"	" Parsnips			4 Pole Limas	"	16'	"
"	"	" Beets			13 Hills of Corn	"	4'	"
"	"	" Peas			6 Pole Tomatoes	"	8'	"
25	"	" Beans	"	" Beans	13 Hills of Corn	"	4'	"
"	"	" Peas	"	" Beans	4 Pole Limas	"	16'	"
"	"	" Lettuce			13 Hills of Corn	"	4'	"
"	"	" Peas	"	" Sprouts	6 Pole Tomatoes	"	8'	"
"	"	" Onions	"	" Beets	13 Hills of Corn	"	4'	"
"	"	" Peas	"	" Carrots	4 Pole Limas	"	16'	"
"	"	Spinach follow with N.Z. Spinach and			13 Hills of Corn	spaced 4' and 12 Eggplant		

Plant follow crop rows 6" from main crop rows.



Plant follow crop rows
6 inches to one side of
main crop rows.

7 Rows	13 Hills = 91 Hills
3	4 " = 12 "
3	6 " = 18 "
1	12 " = 12 "
1	6 " = 6 "

PRIOR CROP	MAIN CROPS	FOLLOW CROP
Potatoes	Corn	Spinach
	Beans Tomatoes	Beans
Carrots	Corn	
	Parsnips Limas	
Beets	Corn	
	Peas Tomatoes	Beans
Beans	Corn	Beans
	Peas Limas	Beans
Lettuce	Corn	
	Peas Tomatoes	Sprouts
Onions	Corn	Beets
	Peas Limas	Carrots
Spinach	Corn	Eggplant
		Spinach

EXPECTED DATES

PRIOR CROPS				MAIN CROPS				FOLLOW CROPS			
BEAR		BEAR		BEAR		BEAR		BEAR		BEAR	
Plant	Begin	Finish	Plant	Begin	Finish	Plant	Begin	Finish	Plant	Begin	Finish
Potatoes	May 1	July 1	Aug. 1	Corn	June 20	Sept. 13	Sept. 25		Spinach	Aug. 1	Sept. 15
				Beans	May 15	July 10	July 25	Tomatoes	June 1	July 10	Oct. 1
Carrots	April 1	June 20	Aug. 20	Corn	June 13	Sept. 10	Sept. 20		Beans	Aug. 1	Sept. 15
				Parsnips	April 15	Oct. 1	Nov. 1	Limas	June 1	Aug. 25	Oct. 14
Beets	April 1	June 10	Aug. 15	Corn	June 10	Sept. 1	Sept. 8				
				Peas	April 16	July 1	July 8	Tomatoes	June 1	July 10	Oct. 14
Beans	April 20	July 1	July 15	Corn	June 2	Aug. 22	Sept. 1		Beans	July 1	Aug. 15
				Peas	April 8	June 26	July 3	Limas	May 15	Aug. 20	Oct. 14
Lettuce	May 1	June 14	Aug. 1	Corn	May 20	Aug. 14	Aug. 21		Beans	June 15	Aug. 1
				Peas	Mar. 28	June 18	June 24	Tomatoes	June 1	July 10	Oct. 14
Onions	April 1	June 1	June 25	Corn	May 12	Aug. 8	Aug. 15		Sprouts	June 1	Oct. 1
				Peas	Mar. 28	June 18	June 24	Limas	June 25	Aug. 15	Oct. 14
Spinach	April 1	May 23	June 10	Corn	May 1	Aug. 1	Aug. 10		Carrots	June 25	Aug. 20
									Eggplant N.Z. Spinach	June 1	Aug. 1
										June 11	Sept. 1
										Oct. 14	Oct. 14

The dates given are for planting the seeds or transplanting the plants. See following page for dates on which to plant the seeds which are to be started in a greenhouse.

PLANTING SCHEDULE FOR GARDEN

	March	28		Peas
	April	1		Beets
	"	1		Carrots
	"	1		Onion, sets
	"	1		Spinach
	"	8		Peas
	"	15		Parsnips
	"	16		Peas
	"	20		Beans
	May	1		Corn
Sow in greenhouse March 13	"	1	Transplant	Lettuce
	"	1		Potatoes
	"	12		Corn
	"	15		Sievas
	"	15		Beans
Sow in greenhouse April 12	"	16	Transplant	Lettuce
	"	20		Corn
	June	1		Sievas
Sow in greenhouse March 1	"	1	Transplant	Tomatoes
" " " April 15	"	1	"	Brussels sprouts
" " " March 1	"	1	"	Eggplant
	"	2		Corn
	"	10		Corn
Sow in greenhouse April 15	"	11	Transplant	Spinach, New Zealand
	"	15		Beans
	"	15		Corn
	"	20		Corn
Sow in greenhouse May 10	"	24	Transplant	Lettuce
	"	25		Beets
	"	25		Carrots
	July	1		Beans
	"	15		Beans
	August	1		Beans
		1		Spinach

If you do not have a greenhouse, buy the seeds and arrange with a greenhouse grower to grow them for you, or else buy the plants. If you wish to buy the plants, make the arrangements early, for the plants named are not usually carried by the seed houses although the seeds are.

SEED LIST

VEGETABLE	AMOUNT	VARIETY
Beans, bush	3 lb.	Stringless Greenpod
Beets	$\frac{1}{4}$ lb.	Harvard
Brussels sprouts	1 pkt.	Catskill
Carrot	$\frac{1}{2}$ oz.	Golden Beauty
Corn	$\frac{3}{4}$ lb.	Golden Bantam, Massachusetts grown
Eggplant	1 pkt.	Early Long Purple
Lettuce	1 pkt.	May King
Lettuce	1 pkt.	Imperial Number 44
Lima, pole	$\frac{1}{2}$ lb.	Sieva
Onion, sets	1 lb.	Yellow Globe
Parsnips	$\frac{1}{2}$ oz.	Hollow Crown
Peas	4 lbs.	Little Marvel
Potato	$\frac{1}{2}$ pk.	Irish Cobbler
Spinach	2 oz.	Bloomsdale Savoy
Spinach	1 oz.	New Zealand
Tomato	1 pkt.	Rutgers

If Little Marvel peas are not obtainable because of Government regulations, try Nott's Excelsior and Laxton's Progress and pick the better for the following year.

PLANTS REQUIRED

If not raised from the above seed, buy:

Brussels sprouts	6
Eggplant	12
Lettuce	40
Tomatoes	18

FERTILIZER REQUIRED

$\frac{1}{2}$ cord well-rotted manure

50 lbs. of fertilizer 7-12-10 with the nitrogen in organic form (or if that is not possible, then 100 lbs. of 3-8-7)

Broadcast and raked in before planting — 45 lbs.

Work in bottom of pea and potato trenches, before planting 5 lbs.

POLES REQUIRED

30 9 feet long — set 2 feet in ground

1 bale peat moss

SPRAYS REQUIRED

1 pint Greentox or New Evergreen

2 lbs. rotenone dust

4 lbs. Snarol

STARTING THE GARDEN

IF you finally decide to have a garden, then get busy as soon as possible, be it spring, summer, or fall. Don't delay.

1. The garden plan looks complicated, but the conception of it can be simplified if you will remember that you are growing three crops in the pea rows and three crops in the corn rows, and what is more, you are growing each of these rows in a space ordinarily used for either the peas or the corn. Or, you are growing six crops where ordinarily you would grow only two. In this way you achieve very intensive cultivation and obtain more pounds of vegetables per square foot than from the accepted and usual garden plan.

All things considered, it seems better to lay out the garden east and west, although it will work laid out in any direction. Above all things the most important is to pick out a sunny location. Avoid tree roots, shade, swamp, and poor soil.

2. Order your supplies, seed, fertilizer, tools, and hose if you have water available. Watering is advisable but not essential in average weather. The garden herein described had no watering except that which was provided by a normal rainfall.

3. Try to have these all done and your supplies on hand so that you can be certain of starting planting on the date scheduled, March 28. Keep a record of what you do on the pages for that purpose in this book — the seeds ordered, the amounts and costs, from whom bought, etc., so that you can always refer to them later. Keep notes on your work. Read garden books; there are many excellent ones. Read your state publications on home gardening. Write your County Agent or State Agricultural College for a list of available material. Subscribe to a good garden magazine. Read seed catalogues, but be a little skeptical of the claims. Visit gardens and talk with the gardeners. They will gladly help you.

4. Don't change the plan or varieties. Each one was selected for its purpose. After the first year, try anything, but if you do, try it on a small scale in case it is unsuccessful.

5. Stake out your garden, making sure that the plot is a rectangle. If

you don't, your rows will not come out right and you will always regret it. Use pieces of one-inch pipe eighteen inches long for each corner.

6. If possible, hire a roto tiller and the man to run it, particularly if the garden is laid out on a grass-covered plot; otherwise, the work will be hard. If you can't hire a roto tiller, then hire a horse plow.

7. Then lay out the pea and corn rows and mark each row with a substantial marker; either a piece of pipe one inch in diameter and eighteen inches long or a solid stick creosoted or painted. It is worth while taking a little trouble to do this properly as it will save time during the busy planting season.

8. After plowing, spread and disk-harrow in the manure.

9. If possible, edge the garden with boards 4 by 1 inches creosoted or painted. This is for appearance only.

10. In the spring after liming and fertilizing, rake the garden plots smooth and then set firmly at least two inches deep the poles for the tomatoes and limas.

INSECTICIDES

11. Starting June 1-15:

Dust the beans and Sievas every ten days for bean beetle with rotenone dust when the foliage is wet with dew, or this may be mixed with water and sprayed or Greentox can be used and sprayed on.

Starting June 1-15:

Spray the potatoes and eggplants every seven days for potato bug with Greentox or New Evergreen.

Starting June 1-15:

For cutworms sprinkle Snarol around the base of the Brussels sprouts plants and repeat as necessary. For cabbage worms, spray Greentox weekly.

The actual time spent in 1942 in applying insecticides was two periods of ten minutes each, both for the potato bugs. This small amount of time needed may be due to the fact that no garden had been grown in this area for some time.

HUMUS

12. Use manure if possible, with leaf mold as second choice. Manure should be spread on the garden in the early spring or in the late fall if

possible and dug in. The ground is then made smooth and left until planting time.

If manure is used, it will require a half-cord, or sixty-four cubic feet or three thousand pounds, of as well-rotted manure as you can find. If possible, get horse manure, as it is better than cow manure, but don't get any with shavings in it. This will be at the rate of twenty square feet of garden area for one cubic foot of manure. When the garden is once established, the manure should be bought ahead of requirements and treated with phosphate and kept moist for one year at least.

13. If manure is not available, leaf mold would be its equivalent if properly prepared. If leaf mold is used, it will require four tenths of a cord or fifty cubic feet or approximately fifteen hundred pounds. This will be at the rate of twenty-five square feet of garden area for one cubic foot of leaf mold. This, however, requires one and a half years to prepare. One method of preparing it which has been found extremely satisfactory is to make three bins of creosoted boards each about seven feet square and four inches high. The first year one bin only is filled with leaves. While being put in, these should be wet thoroughly and 100 pounds of 5-8-7 fertilizer and twenty-five pounds of ground limestone (not hydrated) should be mixed with them throughout the pile. They should be tramped down and made as solid as possible. When the bin is full, a little loam can be spread over the top and wetted down. This will prevent the leaves from blowing. Next spring and again in the fall and the following spring, the bed should be turned over, each time watering thoroughly and adding a little fertilizer and ground limestone. In one and a half years the bed will be about one fourth of its original size and the leaf mold will be reduced to a powder, than which there is nothing better for the lawns or garden. This will supply enough humus for the garden. It can then be used, although it is better to keep it another year.

In the fall of the second year the other outside bin of the three is filled with leaves.

The third fall the contents of the first bin is thrown over into the middle bin, where it is mixed with loam and fertilizer and made ready for the garden and lawns. The space of the first bin is then ready to be filled with leaves once more.

See Leaflet Number 155, 'Compost For the Home Garden,' by Arnold M. Davis, Division of Horticulture, Massachusetts State College. This is excellent and gives the whole story.

PEAT MOSS

14. It is advisable to use peat moss as a soil covering for the following reasons:

1. It protects the soil from baking due to the hot sun.
2. It conserves moisture in the ground by acting as an insulating material.
3. It soaks up rain like a sponge.
4. It reduces weeds to a minimum. What few weeds do grow in the peat moss are very easy to pick out. The roots come out whole and do not break off. It is well worth while using.

As soon as the plants in any row have grown about two inches high above ground, do the necessary thinning out and then spread the peat moss evenly about one half-inch thick. This will take about one bale of peat moss for the twenty-five-by-fifty-foot garden. Inasmuch as the rows grow up one after the other, the peat moss cannot be spread over the whole garden at once. It will take about four applications as the different rows reach the required heights.

15. Rabbits are very fond of baby beans and Brussels sprouts. If there are any around, it is well worth while to build a fence of chicken wire eighteen inches high around the garden. This can be supported by a few small posts. It is an easy and cheap way to avoid loss.

VARIETIES

BEANS, *Stringless, Green Pod*

The finest bean grown. It is so good it should be served as hot as possible on toast as a separate course. This was selected as the best after trying sixteen varieties over a period of many years.

Five plantings are made — the first April 20 and the last August 7. This will give plenty to eat all summer and leave some for canning.

BEETS, *Harvard*

These were selected as being the sweetest after comparative tests of many varieties of beets. Two plantings are made.

CARROTS, Golden Beauty

These were selected as being the sweetest and having the least core. Particularly good when picked very young. They are even delicious when shredded and eaten raw in a salad. Both beets and carrots can be left in the ground until just after freezing. Two plantings are made.

CORN, Golden Bantam, Massachusetts Grown

This is the best of all vegetables to grow, with a long season from July 20 to the first frosts about October 7. The special strain recommended was selected after tests on eighteen varieties over a period of many years. It has been almost free from disease of any kind. The only thing that has ever bothered it has been the squirrels, who try to walk off with whole ears. Seven plantings are made.

There are three reasons for the better quality of this corn in comparison with the ordinary market corn:

1. The varieties usually grown by the truck farmers are nowhere near the equal of this particular variety.
2. Market corn is generally picked before or after it is ripe because of either crop or market conditions, so that of any given corn sold to the market, the whole of it is never just in the right condition.
3. Because of the time lost in taking it to market and delivering it, it is seldom less than thirty-six hours old. Corn deteriorates faster than any other vegetable and should be eaten within a few hours. It is really better if you run out and pick it just before you cook it.

In the corn rows plant the prior crops, and then when it is time to plant the corn, mark out the hills six inches square. At each corner plant one corn seed. This way, two seeds of corn will grow on one side of the prior crop and two on the other side. As soon as the prior crops are finished, the following crops are planted in their places without disturbing the corn hills. The hills are spaced 4 feet apart in the row. This is far enough apart so that no damage is caused by the shadows of the cornstalks.

EGGPLANT, Early Long Purple

Selected because of its flavor and also because it is small in diameter, so that slices will fit on a dinner plate without cutting up. The plant should be tied to sticks to support the weight of the fruit.

LETTUCE, *May King*

Excellent quality for spring.

Imperial Number 44 will give good heads all summer without going to seed.

LIMAS, *Sieva*

These were selected because they are very productive, small, and of high quality. They will bear right up to frost. Should be cooked in a pressure cooker in two minutes.

PARSNIPS

Should be kept in the garden and not used until after frosts. Delicious if cooked the same way as Julienne potatoes.

PEAS

The Little Marvel was selected because it is a very dwarfed pea, growing not over fifteen inches high. Bush or other supports are not needed and should not be used. The vines fall over of their own accord, so that they do not shade the plants growing on each side. While its quality is good, it is not of the best, but all things considered, it is the most suitable pea for this garden. If not available, use Nott's Excelsior or Laxton's Progress.

Four plantings are made, giving a picking season from June 18 until July 8. The peas should be planted to within one foot of the poles for the tomatoes and Limas. This space must be left to allow the tomato and Lima plants to grow.

TOMATOES

The Rutgers is the finest variety yet tried. It is even in size and color with very few cracks and is very productive. No other variety so far tested has equaled it in taste and texture.

BRUSSELS SPROUTS, *Catskills*

These are small in size but are of excellent quality. They can be left standing in the garden long after frost and the buttons picked until used. Each plant should produce about two pounds. Particularly good if cooked in a shallow casserole, au gratin. Tie plants to stakes; otherwise, they will fall over. It is advisable to use an insecticide for cutworms when the plants are young. Above all, protect the young plants from rabbits.

P A R T

III

RECORDS TO BE KEPT

ACTUAL DATES

PRIOR CROPS				MAIN CROPS				FOLLOW CROPS			
		BEAR				BEAR				BEAR	
	Plant	Begin	Finish		Plant	Begin	Finish		Plant	Begin	Finish
Potatoes				Corn					Spinach		
				Beans					Beans		
Carrots				Corn							
				Parsnips							
Beets				Corn							
				Peas					Beans		
Beans				Corn					Beans		
				Peas					Beans		
Lettuce				Corn							
				Peas							
Onions				Corn					Sprouts		
				Peas					Beets		
Spinach				Corn					Carrots		
				Peas					Eggplant		
				Corn					N.Z. Spinach		

[illegible]

Spinach
pounds
Onions
quarts
Lettuce
heads
Beets
bunches
Peas
quarts
Carrots
bunches
Beans
quarts
Potatoes
quarts
Tomatoes
pounds
Corn
ears
Parsnips
roots
Green tomatoes
pounds
Eggplant
fruit
Sievas
quarts
Brussels sprouts
pounds
Bet greens
pounds

I	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
<i>Totals</i>																														

Spinach *pounds*
Onions *quarts*
Lettuce *heads*
Beets *bunches*
Peas *quarts*
Carrots *bunches*
Beans *quarts*
Potatoes *quarts*
Tomatoes *pounds*
Corn *cans*
Parsnips *roots*
Green tomatoes *pounds*
Eggplant *fruit*
Squashes *quarts*
Brussels sprouts *pounds*
Beet greens *pounds*

[illegible]

Spinach *pounds*
Onions *quarts*
Lettuce *heads*
Beets *bunches*
Peas *quarts*
Carrots *bunches*
Beans *quarts*
Potatoes *quarts*
Tomatoes *pounds*
Corn *ears*
Parsnips *roots*
Green tomatoes *pounds*
Eggplant *fruit*
Sicvas *quarts*
Brussels sprouts *pounds*
Beet greens *pounds*

[illegible][illegible]

I	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	IO	II	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	2I	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	3I Totals
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	-----------

[illegible]

[illegible][illegible]

REQUEST FOR INFORMATION

THE author would like to hear from those who follow the plans as given and would appreciate the following information with the idea of issuing revised and improved plans in the future. Information on all or any of the following points would be of the greatest interest:

In what town is garden located?

Description of soil.

Size of garden.

Hours worked per month.

What change if any in seed list or fertilizer.

For how many people could your garden provide?

Amount in quarts, pounds, or heads of vegetables produced.

What improvements could be made in directions or plans?

What criticism can you make of garden or plans?

Was garden good?

fair?

poor?

BOSTON PUBLIC LIBRARY



3 9999 08816 370 2

ALBERT C. BURRAGE'S

Twenty-Minute-a-Day Garden

Mr. Burrage's hobby is scientific vegetable gardening. For the past ten years or so he has experimented with a compact vegetable garden, measuring twenty-five by fifty feet, keeping exact records of plantings, costs, hours worked, yields, etc. From this garden he supplies vegetables for his family of four from June to October, with an average of only twenty minutes a day of gardening.

Every wartime home gardener, whether an old hand or a 1943 novice, will benefit by the concise, complete, and accurate data that Mr. Burrage put down day-by-day last summer on his extraordinarily successful garden. Progressive photographs show how the garden looked from month to month. There is a chart showing the yield of each vegetable and a comparison with market prices. Another day-by-day chart shows hours worked and approximate time for each chore. (Only fifteen hours out of a season of seventy-two were spent in weeding.) A diagram of the garden — what to plant in each row and how much room to allow — comes next, and then information such as where to put follow crops, a planting schedule, a seed list, and the fertilizer required.

And once you've made up your mind to have a garden and have followed Mr. Burrage's directions, you will find in Part III charts for keeping the same records for your own garden.

For a general background book on the hows of gardening we suggest *GROW YOUR OWN VEGETABLES*, by Paul W. Dempsey, which Lewis Gannett termed 'the first among the 1942 victory garden books.'